

Fables & Morals

Grade 3 Reading Worksheet

Tessa Turtle's Painted Shell

Tessa Turtle thought her plain brown shell was dull. When she saw Ruby the ladybug's bright red spots, she wished she could shine too. Tessa painted her shell with red and yellow stripes. "Now I am beautiful!" she said. But when the rain came, the paint ran into her eyes and made them sting. Tessa scrubbed the paint away and looked at her smooth brown shell. "This shell has kept me safe all my life," she said. "It is perfect just as it is."

1. What is the moral of this fable?
 - a. Be happy with who you are.
 - b. Paint washes off in rain.
 - c. Ladybugs are red.
2. Why did Tessa paint her shell?
 - a. For a party
 - b. To hide from foxes
 - c. She thought it was dull
3. What happened when it rained?
